

Chapter 95-1

One look at Ling Dang and you could tell she had been crying for a long time. Her little face looked absolutely pitiful as she lay slumped on Liang Shi's shoulder, tears and snot smeared all over Liang Shi's clothes.

Liang Shi didn't bother asking Sun Meirou for the details first—she focused on comforting Ling Dang.

"Sweetheart, don't cry anymore. How about Auntie takes you out to play?" Liang Shi coaxed her. "Rainbow and Sheng Yu are outside. Do you want to go play with them?"

Ling Dang shook her head, burying her face into Liang Shi's shoulder. "No~"

So pitiful.

Liang Shi didn't force her. After all, Ling Dang's emotions had calmed down a little.

She wasn't wailing loudly and emotionally like before—now she was just hiccupping and sobbing intermittently.

Liang Shi's heart ached just watching her.

Afraid the child would feel worse, Liang Shi didn't discuss the matter with Sun Meirou in front of her.

Liang Shi carried Ling Dang outside the kindergarten. Sheng Yu spotted them first and called out, "Liang Wenxuan!"

Ling Dang sniffled and held onto Liang Shi tighter, absolutely refusing to get down from her arms. Liang Shi patted her back and patiently coaxed her, "Look how much fun Rainbow and Sheng Yu are having. Why don't you go play with them too? They can only do three moves in cat's cradle¹—don't you know the moves after that? Go teach them."

Ling Dang continued shaking her head. "No~"

A child who had been wronged was clingy beyond reason—there was no room for negotiation.

But Sheng Yu ran over and pressed herself against Liang Shi's leg, reaching out to tug at Ling Dang's leg. "Liang Wenxuan, what's wrong with you? Crying, crying—how embarrassing."

Rainbow tugged at Sheng Yu, signaling her to stop talking, but Sheng Yu just stared at her with wide eyes. "Why are you pulling me?"

Rainbow: "....."

Little-adult Rainbow was feeling very exhausted.

"Liang Wenxuan, come down and play." Sheng Yu enthusiastically invited her. "Do you want to go build sandcastles with us?"

Ling Dang was a tiny bit tempted, but still refused. "No~"

"You're such a big kid already, my sister can't carry you." Sheng Yu said. "You're so heavy."

Upon hearing this, Ling Dang kicked at her, but Sheng Yu nimbly dodged and continued in an annoying manner, "Oh right, Liang Wenxuan, you call my sister 'Auntie,' so doesn't that mean you should call me 'Auntie' too? Hahaha, I'm older than you!"

Ling Dang had originally wanted to sulk and feel sorry for herself quietly, but Sheng Yu made her so angry that she turned around and glared at her fiercely. "Impossible!"

"How is it impossible?" Sheng Yu stood proudly with her hands on her hips. "If you don't believe me, ask your Auntie—she married my sister!"

Ling Dang was stunned for two seconds, sniffing through her hiccups, and looked at Liang Shi in confusion. "Auntie, did you divorce Aunt-Mother?"

Liang Shi: "?"

She didn't know whether to laugh or cry. "No, your Aunt-Mother is Sheng Yu's biological sister."

Ling Dang pouted, nearly about to cry again, but Liang Shi patted her head. "There, there, sweetheart, don't cry anymore. How about we go get something to eat?"

Ling Dang choked up, then hiccupped. "I want an ice cream cone."

Liang Shi: "....."

Footnotes:

¹ **Cat's cradle (翻花繩)**: A traditional string game played by children, where a loop of string is woven between fingers to create various patterns. Players take turns transferring the string patterns from one person's hands to another, creating increasingly complex designs. It's a popular children's game in China and many other cultures.

Chapter 95-2

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In any case, it was a good thing that Ling Dang had stopped crying.

At a time like this, even if she wanted the stars from the sky, they would have to find a way to pluck them down for her.

Let alone just an ice cream cone.

Sun Meirou had the family driver go back first and sat in Liang Shi's car.

Su Yao had originally wanted to take Sheng Yu in their own car, but Sheng Yu refused no matter what—she just wanted to huddle together and play with the other kids.

So Sun Meirou took the initiative to suggest sitting in Su Yao's car, while the three children sat in the back of Liang Shi's car.

Liang Shi: "....."

For a moment, she felt like she was running a kindergarten.

Sun Meirou hadn't met Su Yao before, but she had heard some rumors about the Sheng family, especially about Sheng Qinglin back in the day.

Although Su Yao was a bit older than Sun Meirou, they both had daughters around the same age, so they had something in common to talk about.

Besides, from what Liang Shi had said earlier, it seemed that Xu Qingzhu had acknowledged her biological mother.

Sun Meirou had always been cautious and careful, so she didn't dare to initiate conversation after getting in the car.

It was Su Yao who asked her, "What happened to your daughter? It looks like she's been crying for a long time."

"Ah." At the mention of this, Sun Meirou could only sigh. "Last night, my new sister-in-law took her to the supermarket, but she didn't watch her carefully. She pushed over a two-year-old boy, and the boy's head hit the shopping cart—he got a really big bump. The boy's parents were very angry, and Ling Dang's aunt told Ling Dang to apologize. But Ling Dang insisted that she didn't push him and didn't hit anyone. They checked the store's surveillance footage and found that she did reach out her hand and push the little boy down. She refused to apologize, so her aunt apologized to them instead. When my mother-in-law found out about this, she scolded Ling Dang, and Ling Dang felt so wronged. She's been crying since last night until now."

"Huh?" Su Yao frowned. "Did you go check the surveillance footage yourself?"

"Are you suspecting that my sister-in-law is lying?" Sun Meirou sighed. "I watched it too. In that segment of the footage, Ling Dang was indeed in the wrong—she reached out and pushed him. The boy is only two years old, and the bump was quite serious. I even went to visit him at the hospital today."

"That's not possible." Su Yao said. "If a child this age did something wrong, they'd feel guilty as soon as they were scolded. If she's been able to cry for a day and a night, it means she truly feels wronged."

Sun Meirou nodded. "I thought the same thing. She cried herself to sleep last night, and her eyes were swollen when she woke up this morning....."

Sun Meirou felt terrible too. She hadn't slept all night, wanting to discuss things with Liang Xinhe, but lately his work at the company had piled up like a mountain—he'd even been sleeping at the office. So she had held Ling Dang and slept through the night.

When Ling Dang woke up this morning, she absolutely refused to go to school and wanted Sun Meirou to take her to find that little boy to get things straight.

But that little boy was only two years old, just at the age of babbling—he couldn't even speak properly yet. How could he explain things clearly to her?

If they went, it would definitely turn into another unpleasant scene. So Sun Meirou tried to persuade her to go to school, but then she flopped on the bed and cried again.

Unexpectedly, Qiu Zimin came in after a while and asked why she hadn't come downstairs for breakfast yet. Seeing Ling Dang crying, she frowned and said, "What are you crying about? It's early morning—wash up, eat, and go to school."

Ling Dang looked at her. "Grandma, I really didn't push that boy. He fell down by himself."

"It was captured on the surveillance footage." Qiu Zimin said sternly. "Lying is not a good habit. Besides, your behavior has caused trouble for your aunt. She kept apologizing to them for your sake—shouldn't you also apologize to your aunt?"

Ling Dang sobbed and shook her head. "I don't want to! Who asked her to apologize for me?! I didn't do anything wrong!"

So early in the morning, Ling Dang burst into another round of wailing.

This made Qiu Zimin quite angry. She stepped forward to lecture Ling Dang. "Children shouldn't lie. Besides, your aunt helped you, and you won't even thank her or apologize—why are you still throwing a tantrum here? Ling Dang, why have you been so disobedient lately?"

"Grandma, I really didn't." Ling Dang said between sobs. "You... believe... me... Auntie saw it at the time. I... I reached out to pull the shopping cart... I didn't push him..."

Qiu Zimin continued lecturing her. "Your aunt didn't say anything bad about you and even apologized on your behalf. Your aunt was wronged too—you should thank her and apologize to her."

Ling Dang shook her head. "Wahhh~ She's mean. I don't want to talk to her.. She's falsely accusing me."

As she spoke, Qiu Zimin's expression changed. Then she looked at Sun Meirou unfriendly. "How have you been raising her? She used to be such a well-behaved child, but now she's being so unreasonable? Making trouble without cause, being irrational, doing something wrong and stubbornly refusing to admit it... How did she become... just like..."

She probably wanted to say "just like Liang Shi," but considering that Ling Dang was her biological granddaughter, the words turned a corner at the tip of her tongue, and she swallowed them all back without saying them.

Sun Meirou tried to explain to her, but she wouldn't listen. She just scolded her harshly, and Sun Meirou ended up being blamed as well.

What Qiu Zimin meant was that a child this young didn't understand anything—she must have been led astray by the adults.

Therefore, after Sun Meirou painstakingly persuaded Ling Dang to go to school, she went home and cried for a while herself.

Then, at lunchtime, Guo Xinran saw her red, tear-swollen eyes and immediately came over to hand her tissues and apologize. "I'm sorry, Second Sister-in-law. I shouldn't have taken Ling Dang out last night. I just thought I'd take her out for some fresh air. I didn't expect something like this to happen. Please don't cry—I'm really sorry....."

Before Sun Meirou could even take the tissues to wipe her eyes, Qiu Zimin came downstairs, her tone carrying a hint of contempt. "It's precisely because you spoil her like this that Ling Dang has become more and more unreasonable. For a child this age, you need to establish proper values for her—wrong is wrong. How can you still....."

"Mom." Sun Meirou couldn't help but speak up for Ling Dang. "Ling Dang also grew up under your watch. Doesn't it pain you to see her crying so hard? From childhood until now, no matter what she did wrong, she never lied. This time she's so adamant that she didn't do it—don't you want to investigate further?"

"Xinran saw it, and the surveillance footage captured it too—she did it." Qiu Zimin said. "What else is there for me to investigate? Yesterday, Xinran humbled herself to apologize to those people for her sake, and not only was she ungrateful, she even wanted to hit someone. You saw it with your own eyes. If we hadn't arrived in time, Xinran would have been bullied because of that stubborn mouth of hers."

"Just keep spoiling her—sooner or later she'll cause big trouble for you. Ever since this child started hanging around with Liang Shi, I knew nothing good would come of it." Qiu Zimin said indignantly. "And don't forget how your brother-in-law moved out. If it weren't for Liang Shi, our whole family would still be fine."

"Liang Shi turned out this way—wasn't that also because of how you raised her?" Sun Meirou, for once, stood her ground and retorted.

Chapter 95-3

After saying that, Sun Meirou—who had never argued with anyone in her entire life—felt incredibly guilty. She then turned around and went upstairs without even eating lunch.

She had an introverted personality and didn't have many friends. Now that Su Yao was asking, she couldn't help but pour everything out like beans tumbling from a bamboo tube¹.

After listening, Su Yao shook her head to herself. "This sister-in-law of yours is no simple character."

Sun Meirou pulled out a tissue to wipe her tears. "I don't really think much of it. Living with in-laws is already troublesome enough. If my in-laws like her, then she can stay—it's just one more pair of chopsticks at the table. Besides, I don't have to serve her anyway. But how should I put it? It's just strange. She hasn't done anything bad, yet ever since she came, our whole family has nearly fallen apart. Before this, I lived under the same roof as my sister-in-law for six years, and we never had a single argument."

Now that she mentioned Yu Wan, Sun Meirou found herself missing her a bit.

After all, they had lived together for six years. Although Yu Wan seemed cold and aloof, she was always thorough in everything she did, and her personality was stronger than Sun Meirou's—she could make decisions.

Whenever Sun Meirou couldn't make up her mind, she always liked to ask Yu Wan for her opinion. But unexpectedly, on the very first day Guo Xinran came back, her brother-in-law and Yu Wan moved out.

Her brother-in-law was even more ruthless—he stopped going to the company altogether.

Now Liang Xinhe was so busy every day that his feet barely touched the ground, and he didn't even have time to come home.

Sun Meirou had also been trying to compromise and make peace, thinking she should get Ling Dang to build a good relationship with Guo Xinran so that Ling Dang wouldn't be mistreated.

Oh right, Guo Xinran had already changed her name—she was now called Liang Xinran.

Before Liang Xinran came back, Ling Dang was the only child in the house. Even Liang Xinzhou, who was used to keeping a cold face, and Yu Wan with her aloof personality, usually gave in to her and doted on her the most.

Everything in the family was prioritized for Ling Dang first, so she was inevitably a little spoiled.

But it was all harmless—once she went outside, Ling Dang was especially well-behaved.

But now that Liang Xinran had arrived, Ling Dang's presence in the house had diminished considerably. If Liang Xinran wanted to talk to Ling Dang or play with her, Ling Dang had to accompany her. Otherwise, she would be lectured by Qiu Zimin for being inconsiderate.

When had the old Ling Dang ever been treated like this?

Sitting in Su Yao's car, Sun Meirou vented all her grievances to Su Yao, feeling deeply wronged inside.

Meanwhile, the three children in the other car were already making a huge ruckus in Liang Shi's car.

To be precise, it was two of them—only Sheng Yu and Ling Dang.

Rainbow sat in the middle with her hands covering her ears, indicating that she didn't want to listen to them arguing.

Sheng Yu was lively. As soon as she got in the car, she said to Ling Dang, "Liang Wenxuan, why did you cry so much? You look like a little pig head."

Ling Dang originally didn't want to talk to her, but Sheng Yu came at her with a "bomb"² right from the start. Ling Dang was so angry that her eyes went round. "You're the pig head!"

Sheng Yu giggled. "I wasn't insulting you. Have you seen that meme? I saw it on my sister's phone—it's that one....."

As she spoke, she pushed her nose up. "Cried until you look like a little pig head."

Ling Dang: "....."

Ling Dang, who had cried until her voice was almost hoarse, was furious. She was so angry she wanted to bite Sheng Yu, but Rainbow was sitting between them.

Ling Dang pushed Rainbow. "Move aside."

Rainbow made a "shh" gesture at her. "Let's be quiet and sleep."

"You're just protecting her!" Ling Dang crossed her arms and huffed coldly. Her little milky voice was adorable, with a hint of hoarseness. "You two are in the same class, wuwuwu....."

"I'm not." Rainbow defended herself. "It's just that you two are arguing too loudly."

Ling Dang & Sheng Yu: "....."

The two looked at each other, and Sheng Yu put her hands on her hips. "Liang Wenxuan, let's annoy her to death!"

Ling Dang nodded and let out a shriek right next to Rainbow's ear. "Ahhh~"

The high-pitched ultrasonic attack was truly something Rainbow hadn't anticipated.

Rainbow covered her ears and leaned back against the car seat, but then the two of them leaned in close to her ears, taking turns launching ultrasonic attacks.

Rainbow had a look of utter despair on her face. Liang Shi stopped them just in time. "Alright, everyone quiet down a bit."

Sheng Yu had even strained her voice trying to blast Rainbow's ears.

The three of them couldn't stay quiet for more than a moment anyway.

Liang Shi drove the car to the nearest McDonald's. The moment the tires entered the parking space, Liang Shi felt like she had gone deaf.

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However, when they got out of the car, Ling Dang was in much better spirits. She went off to run wild with Sheng Yu.

Rainbow stood behind them, shaking her head and sighing like a little adult.

Liang Shi patted her head. "Did your ears get blown off?"

Rainbow looked up at Liang Shi and said very sincerely, "Sister Liang, it's better to only have one child."

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi was amused to death by her expression. She flicked Rainbow's forehead. "Go play with them. See what you want to eat, but don't order too much—we're having dinner together tonight."

Rainbow covered her forehead and drew out her response. "Okayyy~"

After buying ice cream cones for them and ordering some fries, Liang Shi went to talk with Sun Meirou.

Su Yao volunteered to watch the children for them.

There were people coming and going outside the McDonald's—it wasn't a good place to discuss matters. So Liang Shi and Sun Meirou went back to the car.

Sun Meirou told her everything starting from last night, recounting all the details.

Liang Shi asked, "Why did Guo Xinran suddenly want to take Ling Dang to the supermarket?"

"Just to take her out for a stroll." Sun Meirou said. "There was nothing to do in the evening. After dinner, Guo Xinran said she'd take her out for a walk, then they went to the supermarket. She wanted to buy her some snacks."

"Alright."

This matter was indeed difficult to handle.

Liang Shi asked again, "Does Second Brother know about this?"

Sun Meirou shook her head. "He's been sleeping at the company. He's so busy right now he's dizzy from it all. I haven't seen him in two days."

Liang Shi: "....."

Hearing how miserable Liang Xinhe was, Liang Shi kind of wanted to laugh.

But Ling Dang's situation couldn't just be left like this.

If Ling Dang could cry for a day and a night over this, she definitely hadn't done it—otherwise she would have apologized long ago.

If she was just wrongly accused like this, Ling Dang would definitely become timid in the future and be afraid to do anything.

Liang Shi comforted Sun Meirou with a few words, telling her not to be too upset. Then she discussed with her about letting Ling Dang stay at her place tonight. After all, there were many children at her place now, so Ling Dang would have playmates and could change her mood.

Sun Meirou was also worried that her newly moved place was small and that these kids making a ruckus would keep her and Xu Qingzhu from sleeping well.

"It's fine." Liang Shi said. "Ling Dang is very well-behaved."

At the same time, Liang Shi asked Sun Meirou about the supermarket where Ling Dang and the others went last night, the hospital where the injured child was staying, and the parents' phone number.

Sun Meirou shook her head helplessly. "I just feel like something's strange. She clearly hasn't done anything bad since she came, but things keep happening in the house."

Liang Shi remained silent and didn't say anything more.

Footnotes:

¹ **Pour out like beans from a bamboo tube (竹筒倒豆子):** A Chinese idiom meaning to tell everything at once without holding back, like beans spilling out when a bamboo tube is tipped over.

² **Bomb/王炸 (wáng zhà):** Literally "king bomb," this is a term from the popular Chinese card game Dou Dizhu (斗地主, "Fight the Landlord"). It refers to the highest-value combination in the game (two jokers played together), used colloquially to mean a powerful or devastating opening move or statement.

Chapter 95-4

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By evening, Sun Meirou reminded Ling Dang to listen to Liang Shi and be good. Ling Dang was still a bit sulky and didn't want to talk to Sun Meirou.

In her heart, Sun Meirou had also wrongly accused her along with the others.

Liang Shi invited Sun Meirou to come to her place for dinner before going back, but Sun Meirou said she needed to go find Liang Xinhe.

There were some things she still needed to discuss with Liang Xinhe.

So Liang Shi drove Sun Meirou to Dongheng.

When Sun Meirou was leaving, she tried to talk to Ling Dang, but Ling Dang ignored her. However, after Sun Meirou got out of the car, Ling Dang pressed her face against the car window to watch, and let out a few more sobs.

Sheng Yu didn't understand. "Liang Wenxuan, why are you crying again?"

Ling Dang sniffled. "I miss Mommy."

Sheng Yu: "....."

"Then why didn't you talk to her when your mommy was here?" Sheng Yu asked. "Are you crazy?"

Ling Dang let out a soft, milky huff. "You're the one who's crazy."

She was just angry that Mommy hadn't taken her side when she clearly hadn't done anything wrong.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi spoke while driving. "Mommy knows you were wrongly accused, but Mommy hasn't found the evidence yet. You need to give Mommy some time. If you're angry, you can vent at Mommy, but what about when Mommy is upset? Ling Dang, you're not being fair."

Her voice was gentle, her tone soft and patient. What she said made Ling Dang shed a tear. "I'm sorry....."

"You should say sorry to the person you want to apologize to." Liang Shi tossed her phone to the back seat. "You haven't done anything to wrong me, so saying it to me is useless."

Ling Dang held Liang Shi's phone. "Auntie, can I call Mommy?"

Liang Shi nodded. "Of course. The password is 123123."

Ling Dang held the phone and unlocked it, then found the contacts and asked, "Is it this one that says 'Second Sister-in-law'?"

"Dummy." Sheng Yu said from the side. "Of course it is. Does Sister have two second sisters-in-law?"

Ling Dang glared at her and huffed softly. "You're annoying. Stop talking."

"I'll talk if I want to, bleh bleh bleh~" Sheng Yu made a face at her.

Rainbow crossed her arms beside them. "Childish."

Sheng Yu got angry. "If you're not childish, then don't go to kindergarten with me."

Rainbow: "....."

It was rare for Liang Shi to see Rainbow at a loss for words. Watching the three of them interact through the rearview mirror was quite amusing.

Ling Dang used Liang Shi's phone to call Sun Meirou. Sun Meirou picked up quickly and said gently, "Ah Shi, did something happen to Ling Dang?"

"Mommy, it's me, Ling Dang." Ling Dang's voice was terribly hoarse. After crying for a day and a night, and then making such a ruckus with Sheng Yu just now, she sounded even more pitiful now.

Sun Meirou immediately said, "Sweetheart, what happened?"

"Nothing." Ling Dang paused before saying, "Mommy, I'm sorry. I didn't mean it just now. Please don't be sad."

Sun Meirou was stunned, and then Liang Xinhe's voice suddenly came through from the other end of the phone. "Sweetheart, who bullied you? Why are you crying like this? Daddy will go settle accounts with them for you."

"They didn't bully me—they all wrongly accused me." Ling Dang said. "I don't want to play with them. Daddy, don't go back home. Grandma will scold you."

Liang Xinhe was taken aback. "Why would she scold me?"

"Just like she scolded Mommy. When I wouldn't admit I was wrong, Grandma said it was because Mommy didn't raise me properly." Ling Dang sobbed while tattling, her logic perfectly clear. She could even mimic Qiu Zimin's tone of voice with uncanny accuracy.

Liang Xinhe on the other end of the phone was dumbfounded. He didn't even remember he was talking to his precious daughter and blurted out, "What the f***?"

"Second Brother!" Liang Shi quickly reminded him. On the other end of the phone, Liang Xinhe was also pinched by Sun Meirou, making him inhale sharply from the pain.

Liang Xinhe immediately explained, "Precious daughter, Daddy wasn't talking about you~"

A grown man drawing out his words like that—he was especially patient when coaxing his daughter.

Liang Xinhe and Sun Meirou coaxed Ling Dang together for a while before Ling Dang's mood finally improved. She told them she was going to Auntie's house tonight to see her sweet-smelling Aunt-Mother.

While driving, Liang Shi wondered—just how fragrant was Xu Qingzhu?

Every time Ling Dang came to their house, she liked being held by Xu Qingzhu, saying she smelled nice. When Sheng Yu first met Xu Qingzhu, she also said she smelled nice.

Liang Shi hadn't smelled it very strongly herself. Only occasionally—very occasionally—could she smell the strawberry Baileys fragrance emanating from her body, making one feel slightly intoxicated.

That was the scent of her pheromones.

Chapter 95-5

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Liang Shi and Su Yao took the children to browse the supermarket. The kids each pulled a children's shopping cart. While they were shopping, Liang Shi took the opportunity to ask Ling Dang what had happened at the time.

Ling Dang demonstrated for her. She had been pushing her little cart around playing when that little boy came over wanting to take things from her cart. So she squatted down to play with the little boy. After a while, she was about to leave, so she waved goodbye to the little boy. But the little boy grabbed her leg, and she told him to let go.

But he wouldn't let go, so Ling Dang got a little annoyed—though she didn't do anything.

In Ling Dang's words: He's just a little kid. How could I stoop to his level?

So Ling Dang pried his hands off and told him to stand there obediently and wait for his parents. Ling Dang wanted to leave, but he wanted to follow. Ling Dang just made a vague gesture with her hand, and then he tripped over his own feet—his left foot catching his right—and fell down, bumping into her little cart.

Ling Dang said that Liang Xinran was standing in her direction at the time and must have seen that she hadn't pushed the little boy. But Liang Xinran kept desperately apologizing to the other party, taking all the blame upon herself.

Ling Dang was definitely feeling extremely wronged.

She said she was absolutely certain that her hand never even touched that boy.

She also said that little brat was tiny like a bean sprout—she didn't dare to touch him at all.

Sheng Yu nodded beside her. "That's right. Just like Shen Yiran's little sister—she's so tiny. I wanted to hold her, but the adults wouldn't let me. Hmph!"

"You've met Shen Yiran's little sister?" Ling Dang was immediately interested. "Is she pretty? Shen Yiran said her little sister is super ugly."

"I've seen her." Sheng Yu frowned in thought. "She's okay, I guess. Little kids all seem to be pretty ugly. Not like us—we've already grown to be good-looking."

Rainbow couldn't help but laugh out loud from the side.

Sheng Yu put her hands on her hips and questioned her. "What? Am I not good-looking?"

Rainbow: "....."

Liang Shi and Su Yao exchanged glances and smiled helplessly.

Kids these days were all little devils in small bodies¹. They were exposed to so many new things and knew all sorts of strange bits of knowledge.

After they finished shopping, Liang Shi took Su Yao and the group home. The three kids made a ruckus on the way.

Sheng Yu said, "Wow, there's actually an elevator!"

Ling Dang chimed in. "And there are so many apartments here, so many doors."

Rainbow looked at these two who had always lived in villas and had never lived in an apartment complex: "....."

Liang Shi told Su Yao that this was their newly moved home. The place was a bit small, but the security and environment were quite good.

They had wandered around for a while, so they came back a bit late. Given Xu Qingzhu's usual habit of working overtime, she shouldn't have been home yet at this hour. So Liang Shi took out her keys to open the outermost security door. Before she could even verify her fingerprint, the inner door had already opened.

Xu Qingzhu's lazy voice sounded. "Teacher Liang, you're quite late today~"

Liang Shi: "....."

Before she could answer, she heard a chorus of chirping voices.

"Aunt-Mother!"

"Sister!"

"Sister Xu."

Xu Qingzhu was startled. She opened the door to find a group of children standing at the entrance.

Then she looked up, opened her mouth, and said in astonishment, "Mom....."

Su Yao nodded and asked cautiously, "I'm not disturbing you, am I?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu stepped aside to let them in. "Come in."

Liang Shi walked in last. As she passed by Xu Qingzhu, Xu Qingzhu asked in a low voice, "Are you planning to open a daycare?"

Liang Shi: ".....I couldn't help it. The children all missed you too much."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Two seconds later, she poked Liang Shi's waist, stood on tiptoe, and whispered in Liang Shi's ear, "Go put away the blanket in your room."

Liang Shi: ".....!"

¹ **Little devils in small bodies (人小鬼大):** A Chinese expression literally meaning "small person, big ghost/devil," used to describe children who are young in age but surprisingly clever, cunning, or mature in their thinking and behavior.